Quote Calibration — *practice-run worksheet*

Groundwork Landscaping · fall reset & winterize · internal only — never shown to a customer

Yard: _____ Date: _____

1 Survey the yard (5 min, before you start)

TURF SQ FT

BEDS SQ FT

TREES (COUNT)

SHRUBS TO TRIM

Leaf depth
☐ light ☐ medium ☐ deep

SPRINKLER ZONES

BACKFLOW TYPE

Gate access
☐ easy ☐ tight

MILES TO DUMP

DUMP FEE / LOAD

2 Time the work — stopwatch, every phase

PHASE	START	STOP	MIN
Unload / set up			
Leaf & debris removal			
Final mow / edging			
Bed re-edging & trimming			
Sprinkler blowout			
Walk-over walkthrough + photos			
Loadout / haul			
TOTAL MINUTES			

> **Blowout:** time *per zone set*, not the compressor warm-up. The number that matters is minutes-on-property ÷ zones → your per-zone pace.

✎ This yard's surprises (stuff you'd double next time)

3 Turn minutes into a number

Labor hours total min ÷ 60	
Target $/hr daily goal $ _____ ÷ productive hrs _____ (fill once, reuse all season)	
A · Labor $ hours × rate	
B · Haul $ loads _____ × (dump fee + round-trip drive min _____ × rate/60)	
C · Gear/fuel $ flat per trick — fill once: $ _____ per visit	
D · Friction +10–20% tight gate, street parking, heavy leaf, dogs/cats/kids	
Subtotal (A+B+C+D)	
Margin +15% subtotal × 0.15	
YOUR QUOTE — round to nearest $25	

4 Rules that keep quotes consistent

- **Same formula every yard.** Never "it looked medium, so $X." If you can't fill rows 1–3 on this sheet, you're not quoting, you're guessing.
- **Round to $25.** Odd numbers read like math; round ones read like trust.
- **Never go below your floor rate.** Your rate ÷ hour is written once in Row 2 — if a yard works out below it after friction, the price is the price.
- **Quote separate line items only when asked:** cleanup, blowout, and hauling are one job until the customer splits them.
- **Practice-run quotes don't go out.** This first sheet calibrates you — send nothing until 2 practice runs land within 10% of each other for similar yards.

5 After the job — close the loop

DATE	YARD / AREA	QUOTED	ACTUAL HRS	Δ

> **If actual hours run >20% over the quote** two yards in a row, your friction or rate is too low — raise the next like-sized quote by the overshoot. This log is how a series of hedges becomes a real rate card.